

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2 ♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

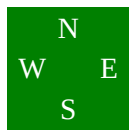
♠ A 5
♥ Q J 6
♦ K J 9 2
♣ 10 9 5 2

♠ Q J 9 4

♥ A 5 3

♦ A 8

♣ A 8 6 3



♠ K 7 3

♥ K 9 2

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K Q J 4

♠ 10 8 6 2

♥ 10 8 7 4

♦ Q 6 5 3

♣ 7

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♠

All Pass

2♠ by North

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 8

That is a lot of losers. But it makes the plan that much easier. You will try to make as many of dummy's small trumps as you can, and you will do that by ruffing ♣s.

Win the ♣A and ruff a ♣ in dummy. Return to your hand with the ♦A and ruff another ♣. Back to your hand with the ♥A and ruff another ♣.

You have taken 6 tricks already and cannot be prevented from winning two more trumps.

Making those small trumps by ruffing was a pretty obvious play.

Lucky for you the defenders didn't see the advantage of playing three rounds of trumps right off the bat.

It would be tough for East to come up with a ♠ lead from ♠ K 7 3, but it would have been great defense.

You have a bad hand. Bad, bad, bad hand. But you think playing in ♠s, ♥s or ♦s would be better than playing 1NT. Can you get partner to bid one of those suits? Sure, you just say 2♣. Partner says 2♠. Your call.

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Your dream just came true. So pass and it won't turn into a nightmare.

The contract would be 2♠ played by South.

North plays 2♠. East leads the ♣K.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 6 3
♥ A K J 2
♦ 8 5 2
♣ 7 6 4

♠ 10 9 5 4
♥ 10 7 5 3
♦ J 10 3
♣ 8 5



♠ A J 7
♥ Q 8 6 4
♦ A Q 6
♣ A 10 3

♠ Q 8 2
♥ 9
♦ K 9 7 4
♣ K Q J 9 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

so the question of disrupting opponent's communications doesn't arise - North is not going to get the lead.

Nonetheless it is a good idea to hold up - **but only once**.

South then plays the ♣Q which you win as North follows. Next you run four ♥ tricks, ending in dummy. You play dummy's ♠K, your sixth trick so far. It is crunch time. Do you now finesse for the ♦K or the ♠Q?

The answer is NO, you do not take either finesse. Instead you play a ♣, hoping South must take the trick. And he does. South then cashes two more ♣ tricks but then he is out of ♣s. Since he is also out of ♥s he is going to have to play either a ♠ or a ♦, either one of which will make you very happy!

The reason for holding up on the first ♣ but taking the second was to keep your options open for the endplay.

If North had not followed to the second ♣ you might not have been able to use the endplay. Instead you would have run the ♥s, and if South did not discard a ♣, you would have to guess as to which finesse to try. With the cards as shown neither would have worked.

Holding a 4-card ♥ suit some bidders would use Stayman. However, when you have 4-3-3-3 distribution there is little chance of ruffing so others prefer not to use Stayman. You take the latter view and bid 3NT with your 11 points.

The contract would be 3NT played by West.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♣K and North follows with the ♣5.

Do you hold up? If so, how many times?

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 4 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 8

Your ninth trick will be either the ♠J or the ♦Q. In both cases the finesse would be into the South hand